

Strategic Brief

September 29, 2026



Putin Orders Russia's Army to 2.4 Million as the US Supreme Court Strikes Down Trump's Tariffs and Ethiopia Accuses Egypt and Sudan of Arming Tigray Rebels

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The Bottom Line

Three developments today each raise the stakes of a different contest. Putin's decree codifies a 2.4-million-man army, locking Russia into a long war. The US Supreme Court has gutted the legal basis of Trump's tariffs even as his administration touts a \$30 billion tariff-cut deal with China — meaning Washington's core economic weapon must now be rebuilt or abandoned. And Ethiopia's charge that Egypt and Sudan are arming Tigray rebels risks turning a renewed civil war into a Nile-basin proxy fight. Meanwhile the Iran-Hormuz standoff continues in the background: talks are still alive via Qatar but stalled, oil flows are recovering toward prewar levels, and the Houthi-Saudi war has killed over 800 people. The through-line is that multiple conflicts are broadening their participants rather than narrowing toward settlement.

Read the full analysis at frontion.news